

Butterflies & Moths

Butterflies to look out for in the park and your garden this month of August except maybe the Orange Tip



Comma
with its unique ragged outline



Small Tortoiseshell
the Large Tortoiseshell is now thought to be extinct



Peacock
well named after its eyes

Look out for them on buddleias and other nectar-rich flowers

This month an extra moth



Garden Tiger



Six-spot Burnet

Both seen by Colin, this one near the cricket sight screens, and this one earlier in the year but could be around now

And butterflies pictured in May and June - most still around



Brimstone



Ringlet



Gatekeeper/Hedge Brown



Meadow Brown



Large and Small White



Orange Tip



Speckled Wood



Common Blue



Small Blue



Painted Lady



Red Admiral

If you're interested in butterflies - have you been to Bernwood Forest - beyond Horton-cum-Studley

Trees

Trees in the park in August

Berries beginning to colour

Mountain Ash and Elderberry



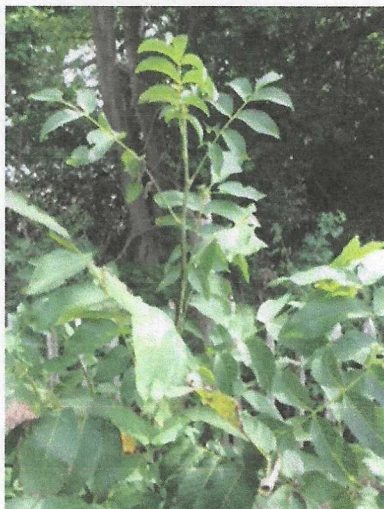
As we've all found out recently, trees are great to have around on a hot day,

but not only can you take cover from the sun in their shade

- they also take in what we breathe out CO₂
- they produce the oxygen we and all other animals need to breathe in
- they clean the air by absorbing pollution
- they take up water from the soil helping to reduce flooding
- they release water vapour to the atmosphere which rises and condenses to form clouds and leads to rain

and they're used in a wide variety of ways:

- willow trees are used to make cricket bats, living shelters
- ash trees to make hockey sticks, oars and parts of guitars
- pine trees to hold up our phone lines
- oak trees are used to make furniture, barrels, and even ships that were made using oak are still around today as are the oak frames of medieval houses
- cedar trees make pencils and are used as cladding and roof tiles
- wood pulp makes paper
- many different trees provide wood for furniture, construction work, fuel



The Walnut tree in its protective fence

Derek and Margaret gave the tree as a small plant to the park.

It was planted out about 3 years ago replacing a fallen willow.

Seems to be doing very well.

Wild Flowers

Flowers in the hedges and edges in this month of August

Still around



Self-heal



Common Nettle



Dock



Blackberries



Cuckoo Pint



Thistle seed



Ribwort Plantain



Common Knapweed



Buttercups



Daisies



Dandelions

Great Willowherb

named wrongly last month as Rosebay Willowherb



The Great Willowherb blooms throughout July and August in our edges.

Linked to the Rosebay Willowherb both named for their willow-like leaves.

One of 197 species in their family.

Tall, up to 2 metres, along stream banks, ditches.

Publicana Dysenterica or Fleabane probably because of its former use as an incense to drive away insects. Other past uses include treatments for dysentery and unspecified ocular maladies! An attractive member of the Daisy family found on the Nielsen path.



Greater Plantain on the playing field, paths, edges. Used around the world as a poultice for wounds and stings. Young leaves eaten as salad. Known by some Native American peoples as "White man's foot" – brought to the Americas by immigrants from Europe, like the Puritans who arrived to escape persecution.

Meadow Wild Flowers

Flowers in the meadow in this month of August

Still around but going over



Cut-leaved Cranesbill



Common Knapweed



Tufted Vetch



Buttercup



Dandelion



Daisy



Dock

Grasses

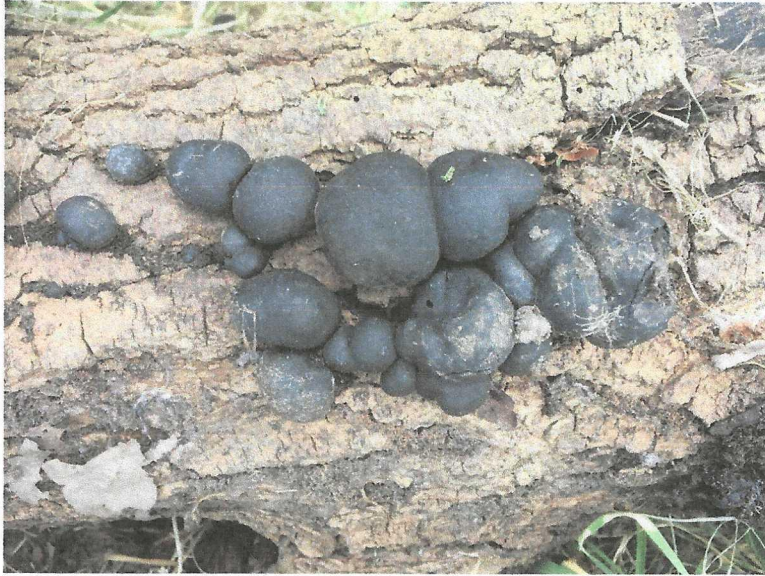
Farmer Haynes will be cutting the meadow later this month or in September and the seeds of the flowers we've seen this year will be spread all over and hopefully we'll see them all again next year.

Yellow rattle are the flower meadow's best friend, because they decrease strong grass growth and encourage biodiversity by taking its nutrients from the roots of other plants. We have collected some seed to sew in plugs this Autumn and grow on to plant out next Spring.

If anyone would like to help with this project, we have some plug and seed trays. Just contact Peter 0779924692

And Other Things

Fungi



Found when one of our volunteers was rearranging the logs by the ditch, this fungus has a variety of names: **Coal Fungus, Cramp Balls and King Alfred's Cakes.**

Daldinia Concentrica grows on dead Ash, is inedible, starts out brown then becomes black – like King Alfred's cakes?

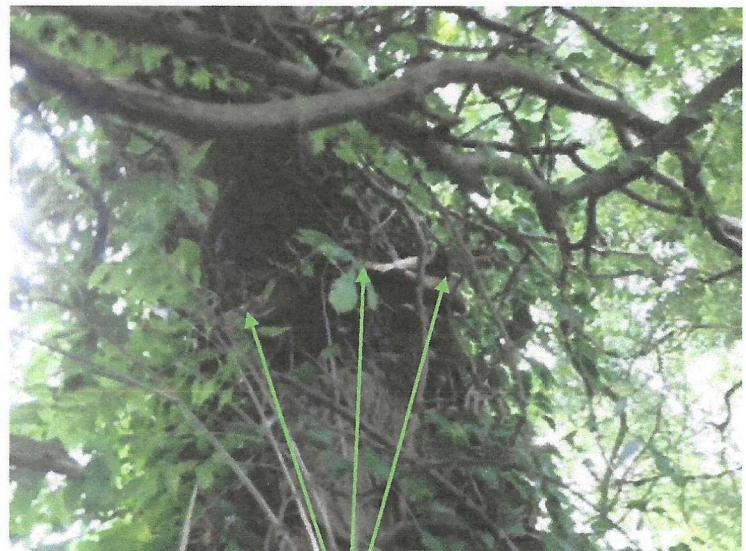
It's always been a good firelighter and very useful for transporting fire cf *Wild Food UK's* YouTube video.

Polypores - Bracket fungi or Shelf fungi (their shape?)

This one could be **Dryad's Saddle Bracket** (a Dryad was a tree nymph in Greek mythology).

The fungus grows inside the tree - what we can see are the fruiting bodies - weakening its host. Usually Ash Trees are affected and the fungus can cause brittle fractures.

This tree has already lost limbs and is due to be monolithed for safety reasons.



The fungal brackets

And Other Things

Close-up pictures of the bracket fungi
on the Ash tree



And the damage the fungus is doing

